Competitor watch · Q1 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q1 2026 trading update**	**771.9 EUR**	**−0.8%**	**+2.8%**	**14.2%**	**+60 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q1 2026 trading update	–	+6.0%	+5.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q1 2026 results	2,125 USD	+2.7%	0.0%	20.6%	+20 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q1 2026 results	4,066 USD	+10.0%	+4.0%	16.7%	+70 bps	Adj. operating margin
Watts	Q1 2026 results	677.3 USD	+21.4%	+11.9%	20.1%	+110 bps	Adj. operating margin
Emerson*	Q1 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2025)	4,346 USD	+4.1%	+2.0%	27.7%	−30 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q1 2026 results	1,037 USD	+2.6%	+1.1%	25.0%	+100 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						

Reported margin comparison

Aalberts		**14.2%** +60 bps EBITA margin
IMI	no margin disclosed	
Belimo	no report	
Xylem		**20.6%** +20 bps Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab		**16.7%** +70 bps Adj. operating margin
Watts		**20.1%** +110 bps Adj. operating margin
Emerson*		**27.7%** −30 bps Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair		**25.0%** +100 bps Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report	

Each company's own margin measure; levels are not like-for-like.

Company detail

Aalberts · Q1 2026 trading update

Revenue **771.9** EUR m (−0.8% reported) · Organic growth **+2.8%** · EBITA margin **14.2%** +60 bps

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Building	369.4	−9.6%	+1.3%	14.5% (13.2%)	High organic growth in the USA; Europe weak (France, Germany); data-centre order book growing
Industry	247.9	−5.6%	+5.8%	17.1% (16.3%)	Business development and geographical expansion
Semicon	159.0	+42.5%	+2.2%	13.3% (10.0%)	Revenue +42% incl. acquisitions

Segment growth: Growth returned in all three segments: industry +5.8% organic, semicon +2.2% (revenue +42% with acquisitions, EBITA almost doubled), building +1.3% with margin +130 bps to 14.5% despite divestments (revenue −10%).

Outlook: Further improvement in organic growth and EBITA margin expected in 2026.

Source: Q1 2026 press release (PDF)

IMI · Q1 2026 trading update

Revenue not reported in this update · Organic growth **+5.0%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Automation	–	–	+6.0%		
Process Automation	–	–	+6.0%		Orders −2% against a strong comparator; aftermarket orders −1%
Industrial Automation	–	–	+6.0%		Easier comparator after the Q1 2025 cyber incident
Life Technology	–	–	+4.0%		
Climate Control	–	–	+4.0%		Strength in data-centre direct liquid cooling
Life Science & Fluid Control	–	–	+1.0%		Resilient healthcare; mixed Fluid Control
Transport	–	–	+9.0%		In line with heavy-duty truck market; strategic review progressing

Segment growth: Organic growth across all six business lines. Automation +6% (Process and Industrial both +6%); Life Technology +4% with Transport +9% and Climate Control +4%. Middle East = 6% of 2025 revenue; limited impact on orders and sales so far.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. basic EPS 136p–142p reconfirmed; sixth year of mid-single-digit organic growth on track.

Source: Q1 2026 trading update (PDF)

Xylem · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **2,125** USD m (+2.7% reported) · Organic growth **0.0%** · Adj. EBITDA margin **20.6%** +20 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.12** (+9% vs $1.03) · Free cash flow **18** (−38 a year earlier) · Orders **2,228** (0% organic; +3% reported)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Water Infrastructure	603.0	+3.8%	−1.0%	21.9% (20.7%)	Orders 675 (+2% organic)
Applied Water	448.0	+3.0%	0.0%	19.6% (19.5%)	Orders 512 (+2% organic)
Measurement & Control Solutions	508.0	+3.7%	+1.0%	20.9% (21.0%)	Orders 475 (+15% organic)
Water Solutions & Services	566.0	+0.5%	−2.0%	22.1% (21.7%)	Orders 566 (-15% organic)

Segment growth: Revenue flat organically; strength in energy metering, dewatering, transport and building solutions offset declines. MCS orders +15%. Margins up in WI (+120 bps) and WSS (+40 bps).

Source: Q1 2026 earnings package (PDF) · Q1 2026 earnings release

Ecolab · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **4,066** USD m (+10.0% reported) · Organic growth **+4.0%** · Adj. operating margin **16.7%** +70 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.70** (+13%; GAAP $1.52)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Global Water	2,035	+7.1%	+2.0%	14.6% (14.7%)	
Food & Beverage	–	–	+5.0%		
Heavy Water	–	–	−2.0%		
High-Tech	–	–	+25.0%		+131% at fixed currency incl. acquisitions
Light Water	–	–	+2.0%		
Paper	–	–	−2.0%		
Global Institutional & Specialty	1,508	+3.6%	+4.0%	23.0% (21.2%)	
Institutional	–	–	+2.0%		
Specialty	–	–	+9.0%		
Global Pest Elimination	310.1	+7.9%	+7.0%	16.7% (16.6%)	
Global Life Sciences	200.9	+10.7%	+11.0%	18.7% (17.1%)	

Segment growth: Growth engines accelerated: High-Tech +25% organic (+131% with Ovivo), Life Sciences +11% (bioprocessing doubled), Pest +7%. Water +2% as Paper and Heavy Water stabilised. Institutional & Specialty OI +13%, margin +180 bps to 23.0%.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS $8.43–8.63 (+12% to 15%) excl. CoolIT; organic growth 2H +6% to 7%; adj. OI margin ~19%; Q2 $2.02–2.12.

Source: Q1 2026 earnings presentation (PDF)

Watts · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **677.3** USD m (+21.4% reported) · Organic growth **+11.9%** · Adj. operating margin **20.1%** +110 bps · Adj. EPS **$3.04** (+28%) · Free cash flow **7** (46 in Q1 2025)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Americas	515.1	+23.2%	+15.5%	24.2% (23.4%)	Price and data-centre volume; acquisitions +USD 30.7m; segment earnings +26.9% organic
Europe	121.4	+12.0%	+0.5%	13.8% (13.9%)	segment earnings -0.7% organic
APMEA	40.8	+29.5%	+3.4%	18.4% (17.5%)	Acquisitions +USD 5.9m; segment earnings +56.4% organic

Segment growth: Organic +11.9%: Americas +15.5% on price and data-centre volume; Europe +0.5%, APMEA +3.4%. Acquisitions added 6.6 pts. Americas segment earnings +27% organic; GAAP operating income +52%.

Outlook: Full-year 2026 outlook maintained.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF) · Q1 2026 earnings release

Emerson* · Q1 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2025)

Revenue **4,346** USD m (+4.1% reported) · Underlying growth **+2.0%** · Adj. segment EBITA margin **27.7%** −30 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.46** (+6% vs $1.38; GAAP $1.07) · Free cash flow **602** (−13%) · Underlying orders **+9%**

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Software & Systems	1,453	+5.1%	+3.0%	31.3% (31.1%)	
Control Systems & Software	1,044	+2.1%	0.0%		Power and life sciences offset by software-renewal timing
Test & Measurement	409.0	+13.9%	+11.0%		Aerospace & defence, semiconductor
Intelligent Devices	2,390	+3.6%	+2.0%	26.9% (27.6%)	
Sensors	996.0	+2.5%	+1.0%		
Final Control	1,394	+4.5%	+2.0%		Power, Americas
Safety & Productivity	503.0	+3.3%	+1.0%	20.9% (21.3%)	
REGIONS					
Americas	2,201	+3.6%	+3.0%		US +6%
Asia, Middle East & Africa	1,273	−0.2%	0.0%		China −5%
Europe	872.0	+12.4%	+3.0%		

Segment growth: New structure from fiscal 2026 (prior year restated). Test & Measurement +11% underlying (aerospace & defence, semiconductor); Software & Systems margin 31.3% despite ~2 pts drag from software-renewal timing. Intelligent Devices +2%, margin −70 bps; Safety & Productivity +1%.

Outlook: FY 2026 adj. EPS midpoint raised: $6.40–6.55.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Pentair · Q1 2026 results

Revenue **1,037** USD m (+2.6% reported) · Core sales growth **+1.1%** · Adj. return on sales **25.0%** +100 bps · Adj. EPS **$1.22** (+10%)

Segment / region	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin (prior year)	Comment
SEGMENTS					
Flow	258.1	+11.0%	+2.5%	23.7% (21.6%)	Incl. Hydra-Stop (+4.3 pts acquisitions)
Water Solutions	391.0	−0.6%	+0.9%	25.5% (23.9%)	
Pool	387.1	+0.8%	+0.5%	33.1% (32.8%)	

Segment growth: New segment structure from 1 Jan 2026 (residential and irrigation flow moved from Flow to Water Solutions; prior year restated). Core +1.1% on price +5.3% and volume −4.2%. Flow segment income +22% (ROS 23.7%), Water Solutions +6% (ROS 25.5%), Pool +2%.

Outlook: 2026 adj. EPS raised to $5.30–5.40.

Source: Q1 2026 Form 10-Q (PDF)

Other key competitors (relevance to HFC 1–5)

Caleffi · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Caleffi family) · revenue ~EUR 273m (2025, Caleffi S.p.A. accounts) · FTEs ~1,600; 13 plants in Italy (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** AHR Expo 2026 (Las Vegas, 2–4 Feb): showed contractor-driven products for North America, including the FLOWMATIC Express Coil Kit, LEGIOMIX and AngleMix mixing valves. [Caleffi AHR 2026 release]

Danfoss · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Danfoss family / Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation) · revenue EUR 9.43bn (2025) · FTEs ~39,300 (H1 2026 report)

- **M&A:** Bought the remaining 38% of Semikron Danfoss (power electronics) from the German family owners in March 2026, taking ownership to 100%. Not heating-related. [M&A Insights]

Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) · relevance 5/5 (very high)

Private (Winkelmann Group, family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs >2,100 (company)

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** From 1 Jan 2026 Winkelmann Building+Industry became reflexGroup, bringing Reflex, Elbi and Nema under one umbrella; Sinus products to be sold under the Reflex brand. [reflexGroup announcement]

Bell & Gossett (Xylem) · relevance 4/5 (high)

Xylem (NYSE: XYL), Applied Water segment · revenue Applied Water segment USD 1,849m (2025) · FTEs n/d (part of Xylem)

- **Performance:** Applied Water Q1 2026: revenue USD 448m (0% organic), adj. EBITDA margin 19.6% (19.5%); orders USD 512m (+2%). [Xylem Q1 2026 earnings package (PDF)]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** AHR Expo 2026: launched the e-80SCX pump with Hydrovar X drive (up to 4,000 rpm, sensorless control) and next-generation plate heat exchangers, with a data-centre cooling focus; BPX brazed plate heat exchanger at CMPX 2026. [Xylem / B&G news]

Spirotech · relevance 4/5 (high)

Private (family-owned) · revenue n/d (not published) · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Launched SpiroTrap HPF, a dirt separator designed to protect heat pumps (3 Feb 2026). [Installatie & Bouw company index]

Armstrong Fluid Technology · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private (Armstrong family) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Appointed Danilo Elez as CEO (30 Mar 2026) to lead the next phase of growth; also named a new global head for data centres. [Armstrong press release (PDF) · Supply House Times]
- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Launched the Systems Envelope Fluid Management Station (SE-FMS) (20 Jan 2026); appointed a Global Director of Offering Management and an MD for APAC & India. [Armstrong press release (PDF) · Megaproject]

ESBE · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Private · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Updated Flexi circulation units (new insulation, adjustable bracket; Feb 2026), new GxF200 and VTN200 valves plus a circulation-unit selector tool (Mar 2026); named Entrepreneur of the Year in Gislaved. [ESBE news]

Fernox · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Element Solutions (NYSE: ESI) · revenue n/d · FTEs n/d

- **Operations, innovation, partnerships, production:** Exhibited at MCE 2026 Milan and CMPX 2026 (Mar 2026); launched a Renewables Product Selector for heat-pump water treatment. [Heating & Ventilating · MODBS]

Siemens Smart Infrastructure* · relevance 3/5 (moderate)

Listed (Siemens AG), segment · revenue ~EUR 23bn run-rate (FY 2026 quarters) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Fiscal Q1 2026 (Oct–Dec 2025): record orders EUR 7.2bn, revenue EUR 5.5bn, profit EUR 1.05bn (19.0% margin). [Siemens Q1 FY2026 release (PDF)]

Alfa Laval · relevance 2/5 (low)

Listed (Nasdaq Stockholm: ALFA) · revenue SEK 52.6bn (9M 2026) · FTEs n/d

- **Performance:** Q1 2026: order intake SEK 17.6bn (+6% organic), net sales SEK 15.9bn (+2% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1%. [Alfa Laval Q1 2026 report]

No dated public information found for this period: Grundfos (4), Oventrop (4), Taco Comfort Solutions (4), ADEY (3), Cetetherm (3), Frese (3), Giacomini (3), HERZ Armaturen (3), PAW (3), PEWO Energietechnik (3), Wessels Company (3), Wilo (3), Zilmet (3), Resideo (Honeywell Home) (2), Victaulic (2).

* Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). * Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December). For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results. Organic growth as each company defines it (Belimo: local currencies; Emerson: underlying; Pentair: core).